



Understanding Group (Team) Work:

Skills



Roy Christian
Career Consultant

Session Overview

- [illegible]



Let's look at Employability



What is employability?

According to Confederation of British Industry (CBI):

‘The possession by an individual of the *qualities and competences* required to meet the changing needs of employers, and thereby help realise his or her aspirations and potential in work.’

According to UoB Employability Strategy:

‘The integration of *subject specific knowledge, skills and attributes* with the skills of personal and professional development, lifelong learning and career management, to enable graduates to become employees of choice and effective in professional level work to the benefit of themselves, their employer and the wider community’



Good ‘Employability skills’ are a combination of transferable skills, knowledge and attitude (attributes)

What are Employers Looking For?

Discussion ...

What do you think employers look for when recruiting students and graduates?



Employers Look For ...

(Your value to employer)

- Academic attainment (often 2.1 min)
- Evidence of **employability skills/qualities**
- Evidence of **work experience**
- Evidence that you have made the most of your time at university (e.g. extra-curricular activities)
- Knowledge of and an **interest in the job** and their **organisation** (commercial awareness)
- Good '**self presentation**' *(at applications and at interviews)*



Qualities/ Attributes Employers Look for:

(Your value to employer ...)

- Enthusiasm / Motivation / Commitment
- **Excellent work ethic** (*attitude*)
- Good interpersonal relationships
- Reliable
- Good time management
- Clean, tidy and presentable (part of being 'professional')
- **Proactive** / Initiative / 'Can do attitude'
- Willingness to learn ... Continuous Professional Development (CPD)



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Employability Skills in Order of Importance ...

According to ISE (Formerly AGR) – *about 6 years ago*

1. Commitment and drive
2. Motivation and Enthusiasm
- 3. Teamwork**
4. Oral communication
5. Flexibility and adaptability
6. Customer Focus
7. Problem Solving
8. Managing own learning and career
9. Commercial awareness
10. Planning and organising



According to *recent research* by (TargetJobs)

1. Commercial awareness
2. Communication
- 3. Teamwork**
4. Negotiation and persuasion
5. Problem Solving
6. Leadership
7. Organisation
8. Perseverance and motivation
9. Ability to work under pressure
10. Confidence

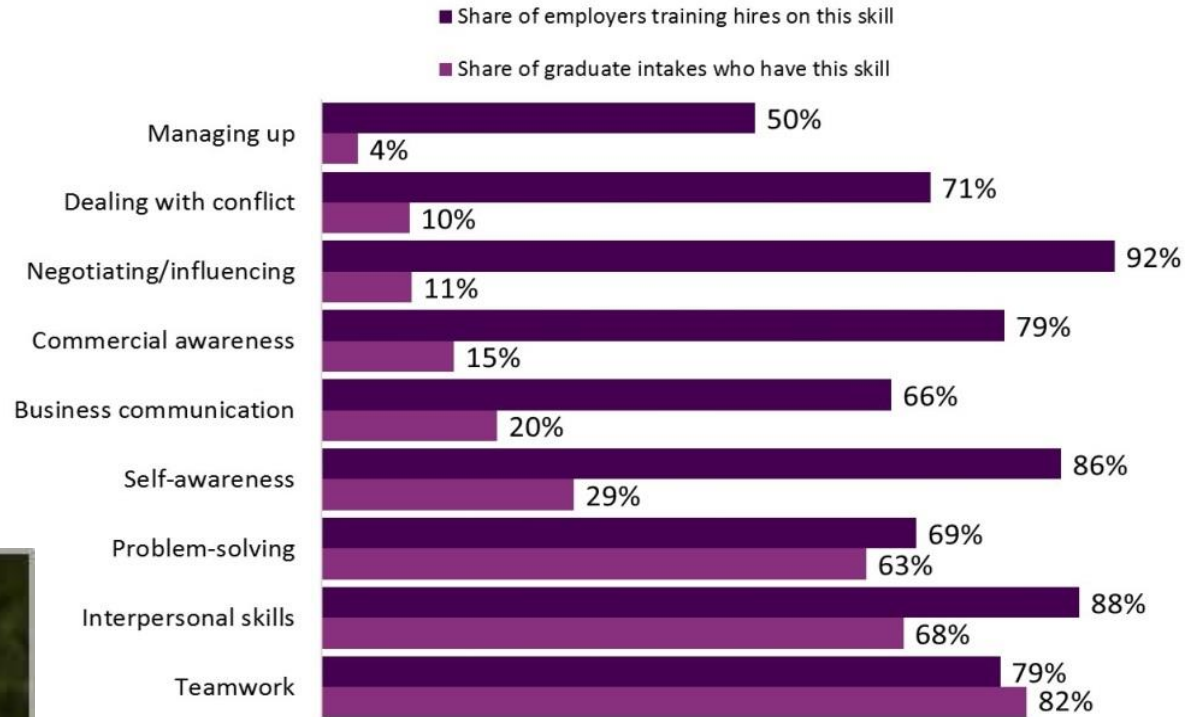


According to *recent research* 'What do Graduates do 2015'

1. Communication
2. Networking & Business Awareness
3. Organisation and Action Planning
4. Analysis, problem solving and investigation
- 5. Team Work**
6. Self Management and Reflective Learning
7. Influencing and persuading
8. Opportunity recognition
9. Leadership
10. Positive Work Ethic



Skills Gaps: What do employers want from graduates?



Steven Isherwood CEO Feb 2017

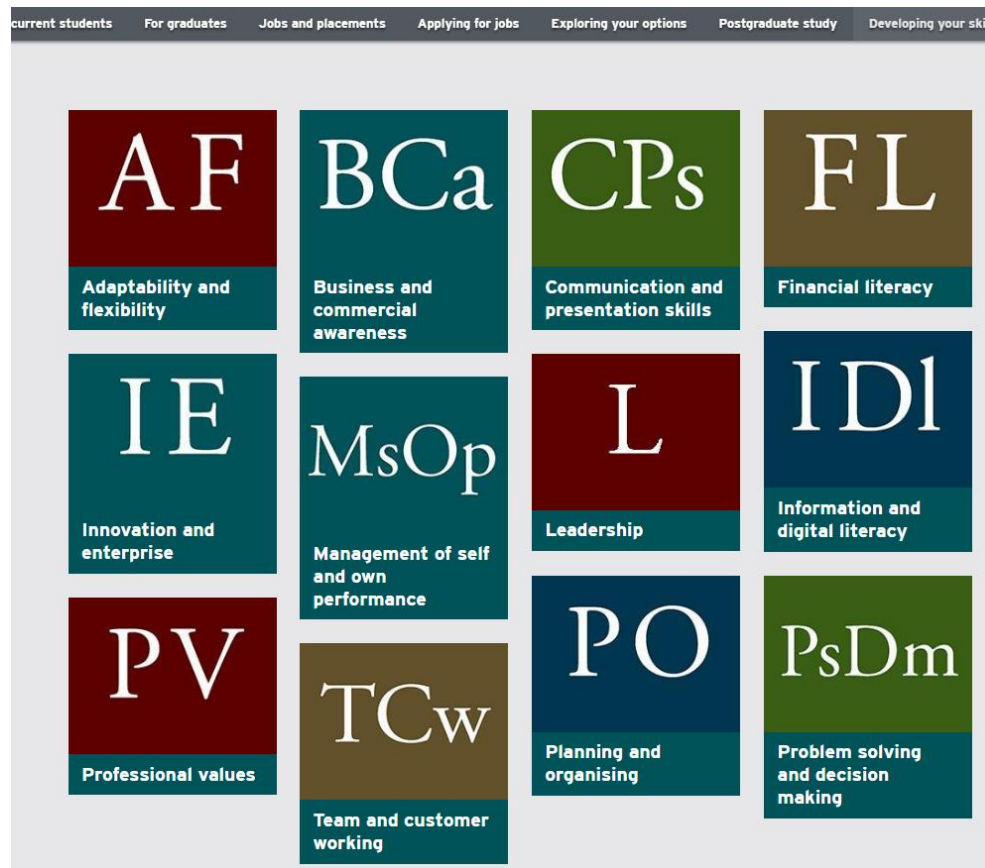
Skills/Competencies – Bfd Grad Attributes

- What are the key transferable skills / qualities employers are looking for?
- Do you know their simple 'definition' and the key *characteristic behaviours* associated with each skill?
- Can you provide/demonstrate specific evidence (quantify and qualify)

Also check the following:

<https://targetjobs.co.uk/careers-advice/skills-and-competencies>

[Competencies – general positive characteristic behaviours expected](#)



Bradford Graduate Attributes

<https://www.brad.ac.uk/careers/develop-skills/>

UoB Capability – Team working

Capability 4: **Team** ... (& Customer Working)

This may include the following understanding and/or abilities:

Team Working

- Ability to *interact and co-operate with a group of people* to achieve a goal.
- Ability to *work effectively* alongside others and to deliver activities *within agreed timescales and standards*
- Ability to *adapt to, and work positively with people's work styles which may be different to your own style*
- Ability to *engage with others* in planning, decision-making , review and evaluation activities

Question ...

What is the difference between a group and a team?

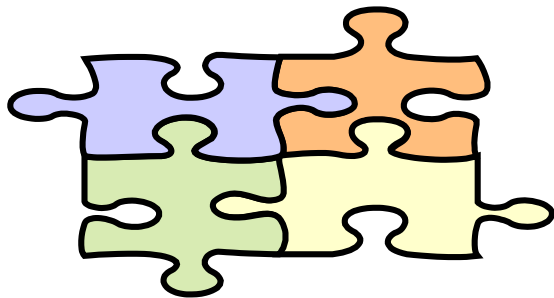


All teams are groups of individuals, but not all groups are teams.

Definition of Team working ... 1

‘TEAM’ [tIim]: A set of persons working together
for group rather than individual benefit.

- work – combined effort, organised co-operation
- work – join as team with another
- work – join in team or in common action



Definition of Team working ... 2

- ‘A team is a group in which individuals **share a common aim** and in which the jobs and skills of each member fit in with those of the others’
(John Adair, Effective Teambuilding)
- ‘A true team is a living, constantly changing dynamic force in which a number of people come together to work. ***A successful team is more than just a collection of individuals; it has synergy***’
(Robert Heller, 1999).

T.E.A.M = ‘Together Everyone Achieves More’



Effective teams ...

So what does a team need in order to be effective?



Skills? Processes?



Theory:

Tuckman – Group Life Cycle



5 stages of group development:

1. forming

→ 2. storming

→ 3. norming

→ 4. performing

→ 5. mourning

TUCKMAN – 5 Stages of Group Development

Forming ->	Storming ->	Norming ->	Performing ->	Mourning ->
• Getting to know you • Agreement on team aims? • Roles & responsibilities unclear • Leader? • Strengths & weaknesses • Testing tolerance	• Competing ideas • Conflict and hierarchy • Increased clarity of purpose but uncertainty • Power struggles, leader? • Compromises	• Clear roles & responsibilities • Adjust to each other's behaviour • Agreement amongst team • Facilitation by leader • Commitment strong • Focus on achieving goals	• Knows what it is doing and why • Communicates effectively • Shared vision/common goals • Disagreements minimal and resolved within • No need for outside instruction or assistance	• Group breaks • Task completed • Purpose fulfilled • Moving on • Feeling good about what achieved • Change



TUCKMAN – 5 Stages of Group Development

FORMING

BEHAVIORS

- The purpose and goals for the team are unclear.
- Members feel varying degrees of commitment.
- Members are cautious, don't initiate and avoid responsibility.
- Communication is low and a few members often dominate.
- Members are dependent on directive leadership.

TASKS

- Build a common purpose. Clearly establish the expectations of the customers or sponsors.
- Understand personal expectations and interests.
- Clarify accountability, recognition, and rewards.
- Assess resources; see who has what to contribute.
- Leader provides direction and drives the team process.



Catalyst Consulting Team

STORMING

BEHAVIORS

- Differences and confusion arise over goals and roles.
- Struggles erupt over approaches, direction, and control.
- Team members react toward leadership with counterproductive behaviors.
- Team is uncertain about how to deal with issues openly.
- Team wrestles with issues of communication.
- Members act from an independent stance.

TASKS

- Involve everyone in the discussion.
- Inquire into differences; include all ideas and opinions.
- Seek further clarity about purpose and develop a common approach to meeting project objectives.
- Assess and test resource needs; make necessary adjustments.
- Define operational agreements (norms).
- Leader raises difficult issues and coaches team through struggles.

NORMING

BEHAVIORS

- Team gains confidence, feels a sense of momentum.
- "What," "How," "Who," and "When" become clarified.
- Team develops agreements on approaches, goals, communication, and leadership roles.
- Team builds relationships with externals (customers, key stakeholders).
- Members begin to relate interdependently.

TASKS

- Develop processes for information sharing, feedback, and resource distribution.
- Have open forums on tasks and relationships, both internal and external.
- Build appropriate feedback loops with external relationships.
- Work toward consensus on overarching issues. Negotiate where appropriate.
- Leader uses a facilitative style to create the opportunity for others to lead.

PERFORMING

BEHAVIORS

- Members take full responsibility for tasks and relationships.
- Team achieves effective and satisfying results.
- Team takes the initiative to continually assess external forces.
- Team facilitates itself easily through the various stages.
- Members work proactively for the benefit of the team.

TASKS

- Continuously seek to improve tasks and relationships.
- Assess and evaluate results against purpose and external forces.
- Celebrate successes—reward and recognize both team and individuals wins.
- Continuously test for better methods and approaches.
- Leader focuses on purpose, interdependent relationships, and conditions that shift the stages.

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Effective Group Working

- Share ideas and find solutions to problems
- Develop a **key skill (team work)**, essential for most jobs today
- Discover your specific strengths in group or team working
- Learn how to deal with challenge and conflict
- Get to know people better



Creating the ‘Team’ in Group Work

- Be positive and open to the group experience
- Take time to get to know each other
- Create a productive environment
- *Set your team ground rules*
- Decide on your group working practices
- Decide on your team roles:
e.g. note taker, chair/facilitator
- Set roles or rotate?
- *Check your understanding of the task*
- *Establish your goals/aims*
- Get everyone’s contact details
- Agree your next meeting date and time.

Effective Communication In Teams

Positive Behaviours ...

- Try to listen actively
- Give people time to speak
- Be aware of your body language
- Be polite and adaptable
- Show empathy and respect
- Put across your views
- Explain your thoughts
- Be encouraging and understanding
- Have some fun!

MIND Tools – The 7 Cs of Communication

- **C**lear – about goal or message
- **C**oncise – stick to the point and keep it brief
- **C**oncrete – solid message / clear picture given
- **C**orrect – error free
- **C**oherent – logical, connected and relevant
- **C**omplete – everything needed to be informed re: work/project
- **C**ourteous – friendly, open and honest

‘Behaviours’ associated with Team work

Definition:

Builds and maintains positive working relationships to achieve common goals. Understands own contribution to wider team goals; actively shares information and discusses issues within and across functions; is considerate and supportive, maintaining team harmony.

Behaviours Expected:

- Actively participates
- Asks others for their views
- Encourages/supports contributions from others
- Responds positively to requests for help
- Seeks common ground
- Keen to work with others from different functions
- Shares information
- Interacts in a sensitive way
- Proactively develops relationships with others
- Dedicates time to identifying and networking with key individuals



Activity in your own time ...

Rate your individual group work skills:

Where are you strong?

but ...

Where do you need to improve?

Importance of Evaluation and Reflection

Feedback is essential to learning cycle!

- What went well?
- What could be improved?
- Which one specific thing you will do differently next time?

Some questions to ask ...

(for your next Group work)

How will you ... ?

- ... manage your teams? – need leader?
facilitator? notes?
- ... delegate tasks?
- ... communicate to each other?
- ... decide on where and when to meet?
- ... get organised and plan?

Teamwork in Recruitment & Selection

- Describe a situation when you worked effectively as part of a team. Tell us about your contribution to the team's success.
- What are they looking for ('behaviours' expected)?
 - Actively participates
 - Asks others for views
 - Shares information
 - Interacts sensitively
 - Builds relationships
- *The above is an example of a competency based question commonly asked by recruiters*



Resources



Check Careers website re: various skills

<http://www.brad.ac.uk/careers/develop-skills/>

<http://www.brad.ac.uk/careers/develop-skills/teamwork/>

Academic Skills Unit: Check link below – various info on Group Work / Team Based Learning

<https://unibradford.ac.sharepoint.com/sites/academic-skills-advice-intranet/SitePages/Team-based-Learning.aspx>

Target Jobs:

<https://targetjobs.co.uk/careers-advice/skills-and-competencies>

<https://targetjobs.co.uk/careers-advice/skills-and-competencies/teamwork-its-high-on-the-graduate-recruiters-wishlist>



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Interested?

Contact Helen Bradley – Employer and Placement Services Adviser on:

Tel: 01274 232213

Email: h.bradley2@Bradford.ac.uk

Email: summerexperience@Bradford.ac.uk



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